

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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August 18, 2026

Dear Tom Purcell and the Berkeley bike team,

I am applying for the part-time Bike Sales Floor role at Sports Basement Berkeley. I live in Emeryville, I ride whenever I can instead of driving, and I want weekday and weekend hours on the Milvia floor while I keep running my consultancy, StaffRoom AI.

Sports Basement treats the store as a third place, not only a checkout line. You rebuilt the old Iceland rink, kept the heritage signs, and rebuilt the scoreboard. The Berkeley bike team walks East Bay riders through the Ava Bike Electric rebate from code to first ride, matching the bike to how they actually ride rather than whatever is in stock. That is the customer work I want: get a beginner on the right bike, or trade notes with someone who already knows what they like.

I help people choose things they will actually use. I start with what they need to do, skip the jargon they do not need, and stay until they can do it themselves. How that shows up:

- Customer conversations: I start with what someone needs to do, then match a recommendation to real use. On the Berkeley floor that means the right bike for how they ride, not the one that is easiest to ring up.
- Teaching beginners: I walk non-experts through a new process until they can run it without me. At StaffRoom I trained an operations team to do exactly that after we cut their processing time 98%.
- Community: Conversational Spanish, used in a Barcelona workplace (English, Spanish, Catalan). I ride because bike lanes are where I meet people, not only because I once needed a commute to class.
- Safety and showing up: EMT (2024). Comfortable standing a full shift, lifting 40 pounds, and staying useful when the floor gets messy.

Your jobs page says you will schedule around another job. That is the arrangement I am asking for: part-time bike-floor hours alongside StaffRoom, including weekdays, weekends, and holidays. I learn product by using it and by asking better questions than the spec sheet answers. I need little supervision. I will finish the day's zone work, not just occupy the floor, and I will hustle the shift.

Thank you for your time. I would welcome a chance to come by the Berkeley bike department and introduce myself.

Kind regards,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker